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|---|---|---|
| | Independents: 22 | |
| 1985 | Janata: 139; Congress: 65; BJP: 2; Independents: 13 | BJP declines |
| 1989 | Congress: 178; JD: 24; BJP: 4; Independents: 12 | BJP support remains negligible |
| 1994 | JD: 115; BJP: 40; Congress: 34; KCP: 10; Independents: 18 | First BJP expansion, after Idgah Maidan agitation and Veerendra Patil sacking |
| 1999 | Congress: 132; BJP: 44; JD(U): 18, JD(S): 10; Independents: 19 | BJP consolidates |
| 2004 | BJP: 79; Congress: 65; JD(S): 58 | The first time that the BJP becomes the single largest party in a hung house, aligns with the JD-S. Both parties agree to have a chief minister each for twenty months. Yediyurappa becomes first BJP deputy chief minister—under JD-S Chief Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy—and the first BJP chief minister in south India in 2007, but his government lasted only five days as JD (S) withdrew support |
| 2008 | BJP: 110; Congress: 80; JD(S): 28 | BJP wins much bigger tally, forms its first full-term government in south India (though it did not win a simple majority, falling short of the half-way mark) |
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